

Ebenezer Daniel G: A Visionary Leader Transforming Rural Finance in India



Ebenezer Daniel G
MD & CEO
Orange Retail Finance India Private Limited

In 2014, Ebenezer Daniel G embarked on a mission to revolutionize financial services for rural and semi-urban India. These areas have long been overlooked by mainstream financial institutions. As the Founder, Chairman, and Managing Director of Orange Retail Finance India Private Limited (ORFIL), Ebenezer has reshaped the role of non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) in promoting economic inclusion and empowerment.

Hailing from a small village in Tenkasi district, (chokkampatti) Tamil Nadu, Ebenezer is a management graduate from the American College. His career in financial services began with key roles at CitiFinancial and Fullerton India. These experiences gave him deep insights into customer-centric lending and the needs of rural communities. This knowledge became the foundation for his entrepreneurial journey with ORFIL.

Building a Neighborhood Financial Platform

"ORFIL, an RBI-registered NBFC, is dedicated to bridging financial gaps in semi-urban and rural areas. Its flagship product, MSME MLAP (Micro Loan Against Property), empowers small and medium enterprises by providing property-backed loans, fostering sustainable growth and entrepreneurial

success. With a vision to drive greater impact, ORFIL aims to disburse ₹1,000 crores by the end of FY 2028, reaffirming its commitment to financial inclusion and community development."

The company also offers two-wheeler loans, making premium brands affordable for rural customers. Under Ebenezer's visionary leadership, the company has expanded to over 60 branches across Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana, and Kerala, serving a customer base exceeding 250,000. In its journey of growth, ORFIL has created over 8,000 employment opportunities for the sons and daughters of the soil, fostering local talent and driving community development."

A Legacy of Excellence

Ebenezer's leadership has driven ORFIL to achieve remarkable milestones. The company has earned recognition as South India's Most Promising Brand and won the SKOCH Award. It has also been named Best BFSI Brand by The Economic Times for three consecutive years.

ORFIL has received the prestigious Great Place to Work certification. This reflects its employee-first culture and strong retention practices. Ebenezer's leadership style emphasizes "making tough decisions with empathy" and fostering a supportive environment for his team.

Driving Innovation and Sustainability

Innovation is at the core of ORFIL's operations. The company uses cutting-edge technology, including AI, for fraud detection, underwriting, and digital collections. Its proprietary FinMobi app, with over 45,000 downloads, simplifies customer onboarding and lifecycle management.

Ebenezer aims to achieve 100% automation in the MSME loan process. This vision reflects his commitment to improving efficiency and enhancing the customer experience.

ORFIL's localized branch model ensures accessibility and builds trust in rural areas. By limiting the sourcing radius to 50 kilometers, the company optimizes operations and improves loan recovery. Strategic co-lending partnerships have further strengthened ORFIL's financial stability.

Recognized Leadership

Ebenezer's dedication to combining business growth with social impact has earned him widespread recognition. He has received the Economic Times Promising Entrepreneurs Award

and the Distinguished NBFC Award from Banking Frontiers. His ability to balance profitability with purpose solidifies his reputation as a leader who drives meaningful change.

The Journey Ahead

Ebenezer has ambitious plans for ORFIL's future. The company aims to expand its reach across India, strengthen its MSME loan portfolio, and enhance its digital offerings. Key initiatives include automating the entire loan process, adopting AI-based solutions, and introducing more user-friendly features in the FinMobi app.

In addition, ORFIL plans to invest in rebranding its branches and launching targeted marketing campaigns. These efforts will further establish ORFIL as a trusted neighborhood financier. Ebenezer's focus on sustainability and operational excellence ensures that ORFIL will continue delivering affordable and reliable financial solutions.

Empowering Rural India

What makes ORFIL unique is its unwavering commitment to empowering underserved communities. By offering tailored financial products and promoting financial literacy, the company helps rural and semi-urban customers achieve their dreams.

For Ebenezer, ORFIL is more than just a business—it is a platform for creating lasting social impact. His vision transcends profits, focusing instead on building a better future for India's underserved regions.

A Lasting Impact

Under Ebenezer's leadership, ORFIL has become a beacon of hope for rural India. His ability to combine empathy, innovation, and strategic vision has transformed the NBFC sector.

As ORFIL continues to grow, Ebenezer's leadership will remain its driving force. His journey is an inspiring example of how determination and vision can reshape industries and uplift communities. Through his pioneering efforts, Ebenezer has set a benchmark for leadership rooted in integrity and inclusivity.

Through his pioneering efforts, Ebenezer has not only redefined the NBFC sector but has also set a benchmark for leadership that is rooted in integrity and inclusivity. His journey is an inspiring testament to the power of vision and determination in building a better future for India's underserved communities.